

English uses the past simple passive to talk about events in the past when it is the effect of an action that is important, rather than the cause of the action.

 **New language** Past simple passive

Aa Vocabulary Environmental disasters

 **New skill** Talking about important events

63.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE PAST SIMPLE PASSIVE

You can use the past simple passive to emphasize the importance of actions and events in the past and to draw attention to the things or people that were affected by the events.

PAST SIMPLE PASSIVE

The buildings **were destroyed** in a fire.

Use the passive to emphasize the effect rather than the cause.



63.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES THE PAST SIMPLE PASSIVE



The trees **were cut down** last year.



The railway line **was damaged** during the storm.



Two people **were injured** in the accident.



63.3 HOW TO FORM THE PAST SIMPLE PASSIVE

